

President Bola Tinubu has endorsed the appointment of executive management of 12 River Basin Development Authorities.

This was contained in a proclamation by presidential spokesman Bayo Onanuga. The executives are 72 in number.

“President Bola Ahmed Tinubu has approved the reconstitution of the Executive Management of 12 River Basin Development Authorities under the Federal Ministry of Water Resources,” his statement read.

He gave a breakdown of the appointments as follows:

OGUN-OSUN RIVER BASIN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY, ABEOKUTA (Lagos, Oyo, Ogun and Osun)

1. Hon. Odebunmi Olusegun – Chairman (Oyo)
2. Engr. Dr. Adedeji Ashiru – Managing Director (Osun)
3. Ayo Oyalowo – Executive Director, Finance (Oyo)
4. Dokunmu Olufemi Oyekunle – Executive Director, Planning and Design (Ogun)
5. Suleiman Oris – Executive Director, Agricultural Services (Lagos)
6. Engr. Julius Oloro – Executive Director, Engineering (Lagos)

UPPER BENUE RIVER BASIN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY, YOLA. Adamawa, Taraba, Gombe and Bauchi)

1. Alh. Sanusi Mohammed Babantanko – Chairman (Bauchi)
2. Samuel Mahmud Mohammed – Managing Director (Taraba)
3. Hon. Usman Babandubu Bakare – Executive Director, Engineering (Taraba)
4. Ibrahim Dasuki Jalo – Executive Director, Finance (Gombe)
5. Hon. Isa Matori – Executive Director, Planning and Design Part of Bauchi
6. Hamman Dikko – Executive Director, Agricultural Services (Adamawa)

CHAD BASIN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY, MAIDUGURI (Borno, Yobe, and Adamawa)

1. Prof. Abdu Dauda – Chairman (Borno)
2. Tijjani Musa Tumsa – Managing Director (Yobe)
3. Barr. Bashir Baale – Executive Director, Finance (Yobe)
4. Iliyasu Muazu – Executive Director, Agricultural Services (Adamawa)
5. Engr. Mohammed Shetima – Executive Director, Engineering (Borno)
6. Vratu Nzonzo – Executive Director, Planning and Design (Borno)

BENIN-OWENA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (Edo, Delta North, Ondo and Ekiti)

1. Hon. Mike Ohio Ezomo – Chairman (Edo)
2. Femi Adeganbi – Managing Director (Ondo)
3. Dr. Austin Nonyelim Izagbo – Executive Director, Planning and Design (Delta)
4. Hon. Johnson Oghuma – Executive Director, Agricultural Services (Edo)
5. Adegboyega Bamisile – Executive Director, Finance (Ekiti)
6. Bayode Akinduro – Executive Director, Engineering (Ondo)

NIGER DELTA BASIN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (Rivers, Bayelsa and parts of Delta)

1. Chief (Barr.) Ebikemi Boi Bosin – Chairman (Delta)
2. Hon. Amgbare Ebitimi – Managing Director (Bayelsa)
3. Chief (Mrs.) Mary Alagoa – Executive Director, Finance (Rivers)
4. Dr. Austin N. Izagbo – Executive Director, Engineering (Delta)
5. Mr. Felix Kurogha – Executive Director, Agricultural Services (Bayelsa)
6. Barr. (Dr.) Nnamdi Akani – Executive Director, Planning and Design (Rivers)

UPPER NIGER RIVER BASIN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY, MINNA (Niger, Kaduna and FCT)

1. Haruna Y. Usman – Chairman (Niger)
2. Dangajere Shuaibu Bawa Jaja – Managing Director (Kaduna)
3. Mohammed Usma – Executive Director, Finance (Niger)
4. Dr. Abdullahi A. Kutso – Executive Director, Planning and Design (Niger)
5. Ayuba Waziri Tedde – Executive Director, Agricultural services (FCT)
6. John Hassan – Executive Director, Engineering (Kaduna)

LOWER NIGER RIVER BASIN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY, ILORIN (Kwara and Kogi)

1. Alh. Abdullateef Alakawa – Chairman (Kwara)
2. Engr. George Olumoroti – Managing Director (Kogi)
3. Engr. Babajamu Adeniran – Executive Director, Engineering (Kwara)
4. Hon. Abdullahi Sadiq – Executive Director, Agricultural Services (Kogi)
5. Engr. Alanamu Ayinla Abolere – Executive Director, Planning and Design (Kwara)
6. Hon. Abidemi Adeyemi- Executive Director, Finance (Kogi)

President Bola Tinubu on Thursday mourned the soldiers who were assassinated in an assault on an army base in Sabon Gida, Damboa, Borno State.

Members of the Islamic State West Africa Province (ISWAP) sent off a pre-dawn attack in trucks and on motorcycles last Saturday on the base in Sabon Gari in Damboa area of Borno State.

They torched the base along with army vehicles, military sources said, on condition of anonymity as they are not authorised to talk on the incident.

Fighter jets deployed from the regional capital Maiduguri 100 kilometres (62 miles) away struck the attackers as they retreated.

Tinubu in a statement by the presidential spokesman, Bayo Onanuga, communicated his profound sympathy to the military authorities following the loss of six brave soldiers during a dawn terrorist attack on January 4.

He ordered a “thorough investigation to uncover the circumstances that led to the unfortunate incident and ensure that it serves as a valuable lesson to prevent similar occurrences.”

“This resolute action by the Army demonstrates the capability and readiness of our military to confront and defeat threats to our nation’s security. Their actions testify to our resolve to eradicate terrorism and banditry, paving the way for a future where peace and security prevail for all Nigerians,” the President was quoted as saying.

“I extend heartfelt gratitude and sympathy to our military and security forces on behalf of a grateful nation.

“Your sacrifices and dedication do not go unnoticed, and we stand firmly behind you in this ongoing fight to eliminate these threats.”

The Commander-in-Chief likewise lauded the armed forces for their quick and decisive response, especially the air component, in launching viable retaliatory strikes.

To Tinubu, the targeted air attacks brought about the significant neutralization of numerous terrorists and the obliteration of their resources as they attempted to escape.

The President wants the military to proactively take the war to the camps of bandits and terrorists.

He especially emphasized the Northwest, where these lawbreakers keep on threatening the lives and homes of innocent villagers.

Tinubu called on Nigerians and the media to help the military’s endeavours to re-establish peace and security in the country.

Justice Emeka Nwite of the Federal High Court Abuja has made an order of interim freezing and relinquishment of the sum of over N228.4 million traced to former Chief Executive of Abia State, Theodore Orji, to the Federal Government on allegations of money laundering.

Ruling on an ex-parte motion moved by the Counsel to the Economic and Financial Crimes Commission (EFCC), Fadila Yusuf, Justice Nwite likewise directed the Commission to make publication of the order on its website and a few newspaper publications.

As indicated by Justice Nwite’s order, interested parties should show cause within a week of the publication of the order.

The judge consequently adjourned the matter to February 3 for a report of compliance.

The anti graft agency had, in the motion ex-parte, sought an order granting an interim freezing and relinquishment of the sum of N228, 497, 773. 12 domiciled with a commercial Bank set out in the schedule attached to the Federal Government of Nigeria.

In her five-ground of argument, the EFCC Counsel said the money described in the schedule, was subject of investigation by the Agency and found in the ownership of Effdee Nigeria Ltd.

She said it was reasonably suspected to be proceeds of unlawful activities.

Chief Executive of Nasarawa State Abdullahi Sule has dismissed insinuations proposing that Chief Executives of the North are locking horns with President Bola Ahmed Tinubu because of the tax reforms he is initiating.

Lead Representative Sule communicated this when he hosted an alliance of denominations under the umbrella of the Christian Association of Nigeria (CAN) on a thank-you visit at the Government House.

Nasarawa State Chief Executive dismissed allegations, proposing that Chief Executives of the North are locking horns with the President over his tax reforms.

As indicated by him, it is only in a nation like Nigeria where you see people who fought against the coming of President Tinubu are currently professing to love him more than those who represented him and battled to bring him into office.

He pointed out their aggregate stand on the need for more consultations regarding the passage of the tax bills currently before the National Assembly, especially with regard to the parts of Value Added Tax (VAT), is what a few personal stakes are confusing to mean that the Chief Executives in the North are battling the President.

Lead Representative Sule said contrary to such view, State Chief Executives such as himself have everything to appreciate President Tinubu for making governance simpler and more advantageous for them.

“I am happy that you are following up on the tax reforms because you called for more sensitization. That is all we ask for. That is all the grammar that you hear back and forth. It is not that any governor has anything personal against President Bola Ahmed Tinubu. We love our President.

“It is because of the President that today, all the projects we are executing, I am not borrowing one naira. All the work that you see going on, I did not borrow one naira. I cannot therefore turn around and fight the President who has helped me to look good,” he said.

Lead Representative Sule, nonetheless, insisted that there are covered up issues about the tax bills which should have been explained for better comprehension.

“Just like I have never been a teacher, I have never been a legislature. Because of that, we called for the withdrawal of the bills to look at it again. They said it’s a wrong language. You can actually make amendments to the bills without necessarily withdrawing it. I said that is what I am looking for. I am not looking for any trouble,” he stated.

On the aspect of VAT, the Lead Representative communicated certainty that he knows much more than the vast majority of those contending in favour of the tax reforms, taking into account his background from the organized private sector.

“The aspect of VAT I understand more than most of them. I didn’t even know how VAT was being utilized. I only knew how VAT was generated. As a CEO of some of the companies, we collected by invoicing customers at the time VAT was 5 per cent, collecting it from the customers and remitting to the Federal Internal Revenue Service. That was my work. Who was using it, how it was distributed, I didn’t even know until I became a governor. That was when I knew that we could collect VAT, and it would help the state towards capital projects.

“When I talk about VAT, I talk with authority because I know what it is. I know how it is generated. I know how much it is. Today, it’s VAT that is making every state shine. Because the amount of VAT at 7.5 percent is what is making every state comfortable.

“Nasarawa State, since they started this, we have not received less than N4 billion from VAT alone monthly. We are rightly apprehensive that all these projects we have, and now they are saying they will remove VAT from FAAC, I had to raise my hand because I have sworn by the Quran to defend the people. I can’t keep quiet,” he stated.

He described as unfortunate attempts by some vested interest to want to turn around the issues by saying that Northern Chief Executives are fighting President Tinubu.

“For some people making noise and saying the Northern governors are fighting the President, nobody is fighting the president. How could you fight a President who has made you look good? This is the truth. All we are saying is that some aspects of it, we need to look into it.

“But you know, in this country, there are a lot of people looking for jobs. So, they want to show the President, they love him more than us. And we are the ones who fought some of those people in order for the President to get elected. We fought them, and they fought us back until he is elected. Today, they are on the other side. They are saying they love him more than we do love him. It’s only in Nigeria that you will see this kind of thing,” he added.

Lead Representative Sule insisted that they are not fighting the President, but that they just needed him not to take decisions that could affect adversely on their chances for another term in office.

“They now are saying they are the ones protecting him. We that are saying, Mr. President, don’t do this because it may affect us in the next election, if you do something that is not going to be conducive to certain parts of the country or certain states. It may be injurious to us. We are the ones who truly love the President for saying what we are saying.

“Not somebody because they are looking for jobs to come and tell you that the Northern governors want to fight the President. Fight him how? If APC does not win and Nasarawa State is APC, we are in trouble. No matter what happens, we prefer APC to win as long as we are also APC,” he stated.

He valued the call made by the leader of the delegation and Chairman of CAN in Nasarawa State, Very Reverend Dr. Sunday Emma, who appealed to both the federal and state governments for more sensitization on the tax reforms.

“I love the part when you called for continuous sensitization on the bills. For me, they do the sensitization, they remove that language about VAT, I will be the advocate of the tax reforms. But the VAT aspect, all things around the VAT are going to be difficult for people who don’t have jobs, especially in our own part of the country. What is the IGR of Nasarawa State. Have you ever thought about it. Those are the difficult things we are talking about,” he said.

Earlier in his introductory remarks, Nasarawa State CAN Chairman, Very Reverend Dr. Sunday Emma said the Christian community in the state are appealing to both the federal and state governments to create avenues for awareness on the tenets of the bills.

“Many Nigerians are yet to come to terms with the provisions of the reforms. It is only proper that intense sensitization be made in order to carry everyone along,” he said.

The CAN Chairman said they were at the government house to show appreciation to Lead Representative Sule for his inclusiveness in leadership.

“As we thank God for His immense love for us in 2024, we wish to, in a very sincere and unambiguous manner, appreciate Your Excellency and your team for piloting the affairs of our dear State in 2024, in a most organized, transparent, inclusive, unbiased, effective and above all the genuine fear of God. For this, we are most grateful, and we pray to God to continue to endow you with more wisdom to lead the people He has entrusted in your care,” he stated.

The Cross River State Commissioner for Tourism, Arts, and Culture, Mr. Abubakar Robert Ewa is confirmed dead.

Ewa passed on Wednesday night at the Arubah Specialist Hospital in Calabar, the Cross River State capital.

As at the hour of recording this report, members of the Cross River State Executive Council and other aides of Lead representative Bassey Otu are gathered at the office to grieve with the deceased family.

He was available at the state’s executive council meeting prior on Wednesday which was presided Lead representative Otu.

Ewa served as Secretary and later, Chairman of the Boki Local Government Council. He likewise served as Special Adviser Community Relations and Secretary of the Anti-Deforestation Task Force.

The Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) has unveiled plans to enhance the regulatory framework governing borrowing by governments and corporate entities. This initiative aims to ensure sustainability and efficiency in the financial system, addressing key aspects of funding for economic development.

Speaking in a recent interview, the SEC’s Director-General, Dr. Emomotimi Agama, emphasized the critical role borrowing plays in driving growth across various sectors.

“Improving the framework for borrowing is very important because borrowing is part of the financial system, and we can only make much of the move we want to make if there is enough funding,” Dr. Agama stated.

He further highlighted the need for sustainable borrowing practices at all levels, particularly in light of the Supreme Court’s recent order mandating direct subventions to the 774 local government areas from the Federal Government. It therefore becomes important that we have in managing such resources via strategic and focused borrowing to help the developments in those sectors,” he added.

In a major development for corporate borrowing, The SEC DG announced significant changes to transform the capital market landscape. He highlighted the introduction of new rules on Central Counterparties (CCPs), which are set to take effect in 2025, as a key step in simplifying and streamlining borrowing processes for Nigerian companies.

“As a Commission, we have established those new rules, and they are going to be functional in 2025. We want to make borrowing a seamless and effortless process for Nigerian companies,” Dr. Agama stated.

He further emphasized the broader vision behind the initiative, pointing out the importance of fostering innovation and creating opportunities within the capital market. Agama highlighted the critical role of legal and regulatory frameworks in fostering trust within the derivatives trading market and establishing a stable, predictable environment for transactions.

He noted that the SEC's framework aims to shield these transactions from general insolvency laws, ensuring a more secure platform for market participants. These efforts are expected to bolster Nigeria's financial system, boost investor confidence, and contribute to the country's broader economic growth. "It is very important that as we drive the growth of the Nigerian capital market, we also drive new products and new opportunities for every Nigerian," he added.

The new regulations reflect the SEC's commitment to improving corporate borrowing frameworks while promoting growth and innovation in Nigeria's financial ecosystem. The SEC's initiative is expected to address inefficiencies and enhance transparency in borrowing practices, enabling better allocation of resources to critical sectors. This move aligns with the Commission's broader mandate to foster a resilient and inclusive financial ecosystem.

Police agents have killed three suspected kidnappers in Kwande Local Government Area of Benue State and safeguarded a kidnap victim.

The operation followed a misery call received by Vandiekya Police Divisional Headquarters concerning the kidnap of one Tor Gajir by shooters in the area.

Revealing this in a statement on Thursday, Force spokesman, Muyiwa Adejobi, said the rescue efforts occurred on December 31, 2024.

"Upon receipt of this information, investigation was swiftly escalated, and the police operatives followed the trail to one Desmond Ahar. The suspect was accosted, and subsequent interrogation revealed the suspect was part of the kidnappers," he said.

"The suspect, Desmond Ahar, then, at that point, led the operatives to where the victim was being kept at Adikpo, Benue State.

"Upon landing at the kidnappers' den, the kidnappers detected the police operatives and promptly engaged them in a gun duel. In the ensuing confrontation, officers were able to kill three of the suspects, while others escaped with bullet wounds."

The Force representative noted that the casualty was rescued unhurt and immediately given medical attention to assess any physical or psychological effect.

He expressed that the outcome of the operation additionally led to the recuperation of two AK-47 and six loaded magazines, with several live ammunition, adding that efforts are ongoing to capture the fleeing member of the gang and recuperate other arms.

Essentially, operatives of the Nasarawa State Police Command located a neglected sienna vehicle on the 28th of December 2024, along Keffi-Kaduna Highway, Angwan Wayo Village, suspected to have been attacked.

Adejobi said the operatives “followed the path and located two hostages who had been captured by kidnappers. The victims were rescued unhurt, and efforts are still ongoing to arrest the fleeing kidnappers.”

On his part, the Inspector-General of Police, Kayode Egbetokun, recognized the operatives for the successes recorded explicitly in the country.

He charged them to support the tempo to accomplish excellence in internal security and safety in Nigeria, saying the incidents highlight the bravery and commitment of cops to keep communities safe.

The IGP urged members of the community to stay cautious and volunteer to play their role towards guaranteeing public safety and national security.

The presidential candidate of the Labour Party in the 2023 election, Peter Obi, has debunked gossipy tidbits of him being arrested, portraying it as “recurring fake news.

Some social media posts had claimed that the previous Anambra State lead representative was captured in Abuja.

In any case, in a post on his social media handle on Wednesday, Obi said the claims are completely bogus and expressed that he is right now at his home in Onitsha, Anambra State.

He reviewed how similar “lies” had been coured last September that the Department for Security Services (DSS) attacked his home while he was in Rwanda.

The Labour Party chieftain said that the motive of those peddling the tales cannot be positive however encouraged Nigerians not to allow it to occupy their minds them from focusing on the critical challenges confronting the country.

“The recurring fake News on me. I have been made aware of a circulating fake News about my alleged arrest. Let me state unequivocally that these claims are entirely false. I am currently at my home in Onitsha, Anambra State, the post reads.

“Such phony News on my person has become a pastime for some people. Recall last year September, when I was in Rwanda, similar lies had gone out that DSS invaded my house; now, while I was in my home in Onitsha, Anambra State, they said I was arrested in Abuja.

“The motive of these peddlers cannot be positive but let us not allow unjustifiable rumors to distract us from the critical challenges we face as a nation. I Thank the public for the concern, support, and dedication to the cause of a better Nigeria that is possible!!!”

Obi had on Tuesday asserted threat to his life following his analysis of President Bola Tinubu’s administration in his new year message.

Obi’s charge follows a statement credited to the national representative of the All Progressives Congress (APC), Felix Morka, in a meeting.

Morka was cited to have said that “Peter Obi has crossed the line so many times and has it coming to him whatever he gets”. Nonetheless, the APC representative has denied undermining the opposition leader or his family.

Nigeria has witnessed a remarkable 63.7% increase in remittance inflows through International Money Transfer Operators (IMTOs) during the first nine months of 2024, according to the Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN). The inflows surged to \$3.82 billion in 2024, compared to \$2.33 billion recorded in the same period of 2023, marking a significant milestone for the nation’s economy.

The rise has been largely credited to reforms implemented under the leadership of Governor Olayemi Cardoso, who assumed office in September 2023. The CBN’s latest quarterly bulletin revealed a consistent month-on-month increase in remittance inflows throughout the year, reflecting the effectiveness of its policy adjustments.

Monthly Breakdown of Growth

January 2024 recorded \$390.86 million in remittance inflows, a 32.4% increase from \$295.21 million in January 2023. February saw a substantial 67.4% rise to \$326.91 million, while March posted a 30% growth to \$363.76 million. The upward trend gained momentum in April, with inflows soaring by 83.3% to \$466.11 million. May and June followed suit, recording growth rates of 45.3% and 40.2%, respectively.

The most dramatic increases were seen in July and August. Inflows more than doubled year-on-year, with July rising 130% to \$552.94 million and August reaching \$585.21 million, a 115.8% surge. September concluded the period with \$336.61 million, marking a 40.9% growth from the previous year.

Several reforms introduced by the CBN have played a pivotal role in this surge. In January 2024, the apex bank removed the cap on exchange rates quoted by IMTOs, giving them more flexibility to operate in the foreign exchange market.

The CBN also revised IMTO guidelines, significantly increasing licensing fees from N500,000 in 2014 to N10 million in 2024 and setting a minimum operating capital of \$1 million for both local and foreign operators. A restriction barring IMTOs from purchasing foreign exchange from the domestic market was later lifted, allowing them to participate in the official market.

Additionally, the CBN established a Collaborative Task Force with IMTOs aimed at doubling remittance inflows. This initiative, which reports directly to Governor Cardoso, has promoted competition, strengthened engagement with the Nigerian diaspora, and enhanced transparency in foreign exchange transactions.

The surge in remittance inflows has bolstered Nigeria’s external reserves and contributed to economic stability. By fostering competition and improving market efficiency, the CBN’s policies have ensured a steady flow of foreign exchange, a crucial element for the country’s financial resilience. As the CBN continues to refine its policies, experts anticipate sustained growth in remittance inflows, further strengthening Nigeria’s economic outlook.

The Lead representative of Edo State, Monday Okpebholo, on Tuesday, defended the suspension of 18 elected local government chairmen by the State House of Assembly.

The lead representative who chronicled events that went before and required the suspension of the 18 local government councils chairmen, cited their inability to explain the motivation behind contributing N800m monthly to leaders of a certain political party.

The lead representative spread the word during a meeting with acting local government chairmen at the Government House in Benin City, the state capital.

Okpebholo promised to support the acting chairmen whose elected chairmen were as of late impugned by members of their legislative arms.

The lead representative, guaranteed the acting chairmen of his support, said he believed they are equipped of delivering service that would ensure grassroots turn of events.

Ondo State Lead representative Lucky Aiyedatiwa has ordered a dusk-to-dawn (from 7 pm to 6 am) curfew in the ancient town of Owo, the headquarters of Owo Local Government Area till further notice.

This was contained in a statement signed by the Chief Press Secretary to the lead representative, Ebenezer Adeniyani.

The government's action is coming after violent cult clashes and security aggravations in Owo which have prompted to loss of lives.

"All residents are required to remain indoors during the curfew. Only essential services, such as hospitals, emergency services, and law enforcement, will be exempted from the curfew," the assertion read.

As per Adeniyani, the Lead representative has additionally asked security organizations in the state to enforce the curfew, guarantee the safety of lives, and properties, arrest perpetrators of the violence, and restore peace to the community.

Four persons were affirmed dead in the clash between two suspected cult groups.

One of the victims in question, 52-year-old Fisayo Oladipupo, a former youth leader of the APC in Owo LGA was shot dead in the early hours of Monday by assailants suspected to be cultists.

His body have since been deposited at the morgue of the Federal Medical Centre in Owo.

Leader of the Indigenous People of Biafra, Nnamdi Kanu who is presently being detained has gone against the solicitation by the Federal Government for the resumption of his preliminary.

Kanu's legal counsel, Aloy Ejimakor, revealed in a post on social media.

As indicated by him, his client Kanu had dismissed the Federal Government's bid to reopen the trial and demanded that the preliminary judge, Justice Binta Nyako, should recuse herself from the case.

Kanu's legal counselor, Ejimakor contended that Justice Nyako's choice to recuse herself was as yet substantial and restricting.

“Our position is based on the fact that Justice Nyako entered and enrolled an order recusing herself on September 24, 2024, and to date, that order remains extant and subsisting. It has not been set aside by any competent court,” Ejimakor expressed.

He further blamed the prosecution of attempting to misdirect the court, demanding that Kanu no longer has a case before Justice Nyako.

“For the avoidance of doubt, as of September 24, 2024, the defendant no longer has any case to answer before Justice Binta Nyako,” Ejimakor explained.

Kanu who is being arraigned on seven counts of alleged treasonable felony and terrorism, has pleaded not liable to all charges.

He was first arrested on October 14, 2015, following his return to Nigeria from the U K and was subsequently conceded bail in 2017 on health grounds after being detained at the Kuje correctional facility.

Kanu later escaped the country following a raid by the military on his home and moved back to the United Kingdom, but was later re-arrested in Kenya in 2011 and brought back to Nigeria.

He was re-arrested in Kenya in 2021 and brought back to the country and has been detained in the custody of the Department of State Services.

At the last court session on September 24, 2024 Kanu requested that Justice Nyako, recuse herself. He referred to a deficiency of trust in her handling of the case.

Justice Nyako consented to recuse herself and forwarded the case file to the Chief Judge of the Federal High Court for reassignment.

The Chief Judge notwithstanding returned the case to Justice Nyako, expressing that two other judges had previously recused themselves, and Justice Nyako, having handled the matter since 2015, was best positioned to conclude it.

That’s what the Chief Judge instructed that if Kanu still wanted Justice Nyako to step aside, he must file a formal motion with an affidavit detailing his reasons, serve it on the prosecution, and await Justice Nyako’s determination.

Regardless of this order, the Federal Government’s counsel, Adegboyega Awomolo (SAN), requested a new preliminary date in a December 5, 2024, letter addressed to the Deputy Chief Registrar of the Federal High Court.

Awomolo contended that the Chief Judge’s decision reinstated Justice Nyako as the trial judge.

Requesting Justice Nyako’s withdrawal from his case at the previous proceedings, Kanu, who yelled down his legal advisor and represented for himself, maintained that he did not trust the judge to be fair-minded.

Kanu’s rehashed applications for new bail have been turned down by Justice Nyako.

Addressing the judge directly, Kanu said, “My Lord, I have no confidence in this court any more and I ask you to recuse yourself because you did not abide by the decision of the Supreme Court.

“I can understand it if the DSS refused to obey a court order, but for this court to refuse to obey an order of the Supreme Court is regrettable. I am asking you to recuse yourself from this case.”

Be that as it may, the prosecution counsel, Awomolo, encouraged Justice Nyako to respect Kanu’s claim of disobeying a Supreme Court order and proceed with the hearing.

“My Lord, you should not recuse yourself on the basis of this mere observation which does not have anything to do with the Supreme Court. It is an incompetent observation. We urge this court to proceed with the hearing,” Awomolo said.

Yet Kanu vehemently objected, waving a copy of a document in his hand which he said was a copy of the subsisting judgment of the Supreme Court.

He continued to read a part that said the actions of the trial court rendered the impartiality of the judge suspect.

He additionally attempted to explain to the judge that his objection to her presiding over his matter was not personal but that he was now presently tired of the preliminary, which, according to him, was at variance with constitutional provisions.

Declaring her stance regarding this situation, Justice Nyako declared: “I hereby recuse myself and remit the case file back to the Chief Judge.”

The Transmission Company of Nigeria (TCN) has said few parts of Delta State will experience a power outage for three hours on Wednesday.

TCN’s representative, Ndidi Mbah, in a signed statement on Tuesday, made sense of the requirement for fix some gear at their Delta power station. This will occur between the hours of 10 am to 1 pm on Wednesday.

“The maintenance aims to address a fault on the 132kV Delta1 busbar,” Mbah explained.

“Thus, the Benin Electricity Distribution Company (BEDC) can not be able to offtake power to supply Agbarho/Eku, Otovwodo/Patani, Ughelli/Shell, Beta Glass, Aladja, Isoko/Kwale, and Imoniyame.

“Moreover, customers on the 33kV Effurun, Enerhen, PTI, Sapele, Refinery 1, Refinery 2, and Warri feeders, which exude from the Effurun Transmission Substation, will likewise be affected.”

The company apologized for the inconvenience the power outage might cause, promising to restore power as soon as the fixes are closed.

The Abuja Electricity Distribution Company (AEDC), last week reported that parts of the capital city would not have electricity from January 6 to 21 in light of the fact that the Federal Capital Development Authority (FCDA) needed to move some power equipment along a major expressway.

Notwithstanding last-minute changes, the Green Chamber will conclude consideration of the N49.74 trillion 2025 Appropriation Bill by January 31st this year.

The Chairman of the House Committee on Appropriations, Mr. Abubakar Kabir Bichi, dropped the hint in the wake of the inaugural meeting of the committee on Monday, held at the National Assembly complex, Abuja.

The Kano-born lawmaker uncovered that the House committees will begin the 2025 budget defence session with Ministries, Departments, and Agencies (MDAs) on Tuesday, adding that reports from the exercise are supposed to be harmonized on January 22.

Bichi made sense of the fact that the budget defence with MDAs will last until January 17, and reports from the exercise may be harmonized on January 22, while the Appropriations Committee's report would be laid at plenary on January 31st.

Recall that President Bola Tinubu had presented the N49.74 trillion 2025 Budget (Appropriation Bill) before a joint session of the National Assembly on December 18, 2024.

The House passed the budget through second reading on December 19, 2024, and referred it to the Appropriations Committee, with all Standing Committees as subcommittees for additional legislative action.

Bichi guaranteed that the panel and standing committees will be careful with the budget defence in the interest of Nigerians.

He noted: "We just had the inauguration meeting today for the 2025 Appropriation Bill, which you have been aware that the President has presented the budget to us, and by tomorrow, we will start the budget defence with all the MDAs. From tomorrow to the 17th, we are going to do our budget defence, and we will likely harmonize on the 22nd, and, God willing, by the 31st, we are going to lay our reports.

"We are going to study the budget; all our committees will study the budget. I believe the budget is for Nigerians, for our development, infrastructure and other important things, and I am sure Nigerians will be happy with it.

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"But what we do first, we complete our reports. Now we are going to study the budget, all our committees will study the budget, and I believe the budget is for Nigerians. It's for development, infrastructures, and other important things, and I'm sure Nigerians will be happy with it."

President Bola Tinubu (right) has touched down in Accra, Ghana, to attend the inauguration of President-elect John Mahama on January 7, 2025.

Tinubu arrived at the Kotoka International Airport and was received by the Chief of Staff to Ghana President, Julius Debra.

Mahama, who fills in as the 12th president of Ghana between 2011 and 2017, was reelected in December 2024. He will take over from President Nana Akuffo-Addo (2017-2025).

Tinubu, as Chairman of the ECOWAS Authority of Heads of State and Government, would join other African leaders at the ceremony.

Kano State Chief Executive Abba Kabir Yusuf has announced portfolios to the newly appointed commissioners, permanent secretaries, and special advisers.

Before their primary places of assignment were made known, the new appointees took renewed oaths of allegiance and office.

In the new appointment, Shehu Wada Sagagi, former Chief of Staff now commissioner of the Ministry of Investment, Commerce, and Trade; AbdulKadir Abdulsalam, former Accountant General (AG) as Commissioner for Rural and Community Development while Ibrahim Abdullahi Waiye takes over the Ministry of Information and Internal Affairs.

Dr Gadaffi Shehu Sani resumed the newly established Ministry of Power and Sustainable Energy, Dr. Dahiru Hashim is the Commissioner for Environment, Dr. Ismail Aliyu DanMaraya is the Commissioner for Finance and Nura Iro Ma'aji is the Commissioner for Procurement and Project Monitoring.

The 13 special advisers and six permanent secretaries equally took oaths administered by the Attorney General and Commissioner for Justice, Barr. Isa Haruna Dederi.

Yusuf made sense of the fact that he has assembled the new appointees on merit to solidify his administration's policies while discharging campaign vows.

The State Chief Executive emphasized that while celebrating milestone accomplishments his administration recorded, he is ready to face challenges ahead.

He encouraged the new members of the state executive Council to rededicate themselves to meeting public expectations.

"The expectations from Kano residents are high. We must work hard together to meet the demands of the people. Let me draw your attention that your office is public office. You must work in public interest," he said.

"I want to urge you to foster inclusiveness and discharge your duties with honesty, dedication, and trust. You must hold the trust firmly and in the overall interest of the state. You must measure up and set standards in the interest of the public," Yusuf cautioned.

Speaking on behalf of the new appointees, the new commissioner for Investment, Commerce, and Trade, Sagagi commended the State Chief Executive for the opportunity to serve in the public office.

He said the new appointees would stay committed and loyal to discharge their entrusted responsibility in their respective capabilities.

